

really difficult to align your income with your lifestyle. The generational difference in how much you need to earn to afford a certain lifestyle or financial comfort and security is also quite huge, meaning that aiming for the same lifestyle trajectory as your parents, even while working in a similar job and having similar spending habits to them, might just be completely impossible.

Taking a better-late-than-never approach to this, now is as good a time as any to start thinking about your lifestyle, what you want for your future, and how well that matches up to your income or earning potential. This potentially opens up lots of different questions, because most of us commit to, and work hard at, a particular career from our early to mid-twenties onwards, if not earlier, and making a change can feel huge and daunting. But it's better to look at the reality of what your career will afford you, because if your career path and your lifestyle aspirations are wildly out of sync, it can create a perfect storm of resentment and frustration, or push you to make ill-advised credit decisions as you struggle to afford the lifestyle that you want on the salary that you've got. But it doesn't have to be that way. Focusing on creating a lifestyle that will make you happy above and beyond material wealth and the numbers on your bank statement is a much better approach than focussing on monetary amounts, and identifying the best places to use your resources in order to squeeze maximum happiness and fulfilment out of them is at the core of lifestyle design. Think about how you want to live, look at what you've